Jones Paintsil

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics • Applied Microeconomics • Development Economics • Health Economics

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Education

•Howard University *August 2022 – Present*

Ph.D., Economics (expected Spring 2027) Washington, DC

– Fields: Applied Microeconomics; Development and Health Economics.

– Graduate coursework in Data Science (2023 – 2024): Introduction to Applied Data Science; Computational Social Justice; Statistical Measurement and Modeling for Social Justice; Applied Data Science for Social Impact.

•Howard University *August 2022 – May 2025*

M.A., Economics Washington, DC

•University of Cape Coast *August 2017 – May 2019*

M.S., Economics Cape Coast, Ghana

– Thesis: *Effect of Financial Exclusion on Poverty.*

•University of Cape Coast *September 2012 – May 2016*

B.A., Economics and Mathematics Cape Coast, Ghana

Research Interests

Applied Microeconomics • Development Economics • Health Economics

Job Market Paper

1. **Outage Duration, Capital, and Firm Backup-Power Choice in Developing Countries.** *Under review, Energy Policy.* The paper develops a model of the firm's backup-power choice in which a generator can switch on instantly when the grid fails, whereas solar without storage is intermittent, which implies that outage duration should drive generator ownership and firm capability should drive solar adoption. Using the most recent World Bank Enterprise Surveys for 11,252 firms in 36 developing economies, it tests these predictions with linear probability and multinomial logit models, instrumenting outage exposure with the outages reported by other firms in the same locality. The paper finds that generator ownership rises with the duration of outages rather than their frequency, whereas solar adoption responds weakly to outages and tracks firm size, exporting, and digital presence. Cheaper panels alone will not move firms off diesel; financing for solar with storage is the relevant policy margin.

Papers Under Review

1. **Artificial Intelligence Readiness, Adoption, and Productivity: Firm-Level Evidence from Low- and Middle-Income Countries.** *Under review, World Development.* Builds a firm-level artificial intelligence readiness index for 44,221 firms across 76 economies; human capital is most strongly associated with labour productivity, while digital business practices are more closely associated with AI adoption.

2. **Prior Digital Presence and the Diffusion of Artificial Intelligence among Firms in Developing Economies** (with E. Asiedu). *Under review, World Development.* Links baseline World Bank Enterprise Surveys to a 2026 follow-up survey in seven economies (India, Jordan, Kenya, Malaysia, Mexico, Nigeria, Thailand) and shows that firms with a website at baseline are 8.61 percentage points more likely to adopt artificial intelligence subsequently (11.12 under inclusive timing) and, among adopters, use artificial intelligence across more business functions.

3. **Maternal Intimate Partner Violence and Child Nutrition in Sub-Saharan Africa: Associations, Mechanisms, and the Limits of Community-Based Instruments** (with E. Asiedu, N. Gaekwad, P. A. Paintsil). *Under review, Women & Health.* Using Demographic and Health Survey data on 125,375 children in 27 Sub-Saharan African countries, the paper shows that maternal past-year intimate partner violence is associated with a 0.046 standard deviation reduction in child height-for-age and a 0.021 standard deviation reduction in weight-for-age, driven mainly by physical violence.

Publications

Google Scholar: 159 citations • h-index 6 • i10-index 5 (as of October 2026)

1. Financial Liberalization and its Implications for Private Savings in Sub-Saharan Africa (with E. Asiedu, F. Asiseh, T. Mannah-Blankson). In R. Ngugi & K. Sen (Eds.), *The Domestic Savings Shortfall in Sub-Saharan Africa: What Can Be Done About It?* WIDER Studies in Development Economics. Oxford University Press (2025).

2. Social determinants of child abuse (with E.K. Ameyaw et al.). *PLoS ONE*, 19(7), e0305778 (2024).

3. Influence of type of violence on women's help-seeking behavior (with E.K. Ameyaw et al.). *PLoS ONE*, 19(3), e0297308 (2024).

4. Gender differences in the acceptance of wife-beating (with E.K. Ameyaw et al.). *BMC Women's Health*, 23, 451 (2023).

5. Health facility delivery and early breastfeeding initiation (with E.K. Ameyaw et al.). *Health Science Reports*, 6(5), e1263 (2023).

6. Reducing children's malnutrition by increasing mothers' health insurance coverage (with R.E. Kofinti, I.K. Koomson, E.K. Ameyaw). *Economic Modelling*, 117, 106049 (2022).

7. Women's empowerment indicators and contraceptive method use (with E.K. Ameyaw et al.). *Reproductive Health*, 19, 222 (2022).

8. On the Impact of Income per Capita on Health Outcomes (with E. Asiedu et al.). *International Journal of Innovation and Economic Development*, Volume 8, Issue 5 (2022).

Working Papers

1. **Early-Life Drought Exposure and Child Nutrition in Sub-Saharan Africa**. Links drought in the first 24 months of life, measured by the climatic water deficit, to 378,234 children under five in 34 countries (Demographic and Health Surveys). The results show that a one standard deviation increase in the water deficit lowers height-for-age by about 0.16 standard deviations and raises stunting by about three percentage points, with no effect on weight-for-age.

2. **Disability and Labour Market Outcomes in Ghana: Evidence from the Population and Housing Census** (with E. Ameyaw, P. A. Paintsil). Using the 2021 Ghana Population and Housing Census, the paper shows that the employment gap between persons with and without disability is largest for those with self-care (36.9 percentage points) and communication (28.6 percentage points) limitations and rises steeply with severity.

3. Does Bringing Government Closer to the People Build Human Capital? Difference-in-Differences Evidence from Ghana's 2012 and 2018 District Creation.

4. Vegetation Decline and Housing Informality: District-Level Evidence from Ghana (with J. Bonilla).

5. Emigration Transformation in Ghana: Volume Growth and Corridor Diversification.

Teaching Experience

•Howard University *Spring 2026; Spring 2027 (scheduled)*

Instructor, Business Statistics (ECON 180) Washington, DC

- Teach undergraduate business statistics, covering descriptive statistics, probability distributions, hypothesis testing, regression analysis, and statistical inference.
- Administer and grade all course assessments, including assignments, quizzes, and examinations.

•University of Cape Coast *August 2020 – December 2020*

Instructor, Research Methods (Master of Business Administration) Cape Coast, Ghana

- Taught research methods to Master of Business Administration students using Stata for bivariate and multivariate analysis; managed assessment and grading.

Teaching Interests

Undergraduate and graduate: Principles of Economics; Statistics; Econometrics; Applied Microeconomics; Development Economics; Health Economics; Environmental and Energy Economics.

Research Experience

•The World Bank Group *December 2024 – Present*

Consultant, Enterprise Analysis Unit Washington, DC

- Design and apply consistency, outlier, and completeness checks during fieldwork and data cleaning, and validate the weighted estimates behind the country indicators released on the Enterprise Surveys website.
- Designed and coded a large-language-model quality-control engine, built into the unit's Stata workflow, that screens open-ended survey responses for sensitive information, nonresponse, and answers of the wrong type before public release.

•Research Assistant to Elizabeth Asiedu *2023 – Present*

United States

– Built econometric models and led data cleaning and analysis, co-authoring *Financial Liberalization and Its Implications for Private Savings in Sub-Saharan Africa* (United Nations University World Institute for Development Economics Research; Oxford University Press, 2025).

•Ghana Statistical Service *November 2020 – September 2021*

Supervisor, Ghana Population and Housing Census Accra, Ghana

– Supervised field data collection and teams, generating actionable progress reports on gaps, errors, and Global Positioning System issues and raising data accuracy by approximately 30% through systematic monitoring and headquarters reporting.

•University of Cape Coast *2019 – 2021*

Research Assistant Cape Coast, Ghana

– Co-authored five peer-reviewed publications in *Economic Modelling*, *PLoS ONE*, and *BMC Women's Health*, contributing econometric modeling, data cleaning, and literature reviews.

Conference and Seminar Presentations

Artificial Intelligence Readiness, Adoption, and Productivity: Department of Economics Seminar, Howard University, Washington, DC (scheduled).
Outage Duration, Capital, and Firm Backup-Power Choice: Department of Economics Seminar, Howard University, Washington, DC (scheduled).
Weather Shocks and Health: Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa. Southern Economic Association, Tampa, Florida (November 2025).
Intimate Partner Violence and Child Health Outcomes: Western Economic Association International, San Francisco (June 2025).
Intergenerational Transmission of Intimate Partner Violence: Western Economic Association International (March 2023).
Financial Liberalization and Private Savings: United Nations University World Institute for Development Economics Research (April 2022).

Awards & Fellowships

Sasakawa Fellowship, Department of Economics, Howard University (2025 – 2027)
Departmental Funding (Graduate Assistantship), Department of Economics, Howard University (2022 – 2025)

Certifications (Coursera, 2026)

Generative Artificial Intelligence: AI Automation with Claude (Advancing Women in Tech / Anthropic); Claude Code: Software Engineering with Generative AI Agents; Agentic AI and AI Agents: A Primer for Leaders; OpenAI GPTs: Creating Your Own Custom AI Assistants (Vanderbilt University)
Geographic Information Systems: Introduction to GIS Mapping (University of Toronto)

Technical Skills

Programming & Software: Stata, R, Python, SQL, LaTeX, Geographic Information Systems; Git/GitHub
Methods: Applied microeconometrics, panel and cross-section methods, causal inference, survey and census microdata, time series

Professional Memberships

American Economic Association • Southern Economic Association • Association for the Advancement of African Women Economists • African Finance and Economics Association

References

Available upon request.